

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	SFT5051
Subject Title	International Study Tours and Workshops (Europe/North America)
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	The goals of this subject will enable students to 1. Understand the influences of western cultures on contemporary fashion and fashion marketing in Europe/North America and to highlight the forces that are currently at play; 2. Familiarize themselves with the Western consumer demographics and the psychographics of some dominant and the emerging markets in the West; 3. Recognize the leading fashion business establishments in the West, with special emphasis on the selected city in Europe or North America and to understand what makes them successful; and 4. Evaluate the effectiveness of various types of retail-marketing as well as production facilities from apparel to accessories in the region.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) Appreciate the socio-cultural orientations in global fashion markets; b) Manage and understand the cultural differences and similarities in an era of globalization; and c) Understand the role of a western fashion capital in the global context as well as the challenges and opportunities in it.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	1. <u>Fashion, Cultures and Styles in the West</u> American/ European fashion history and development; fashion capitals in the world; Influences of popular cultures and entertainment on fashion trends and styles; current development of fashion and creative industry; site visits to some designer houses and

	retail establishments and meetings with designers and representatives of companies. 2. <u>Development of Retail and Marketing Services</u> Retail and marketing systems in the West; cultural marketing and branding strategies; the impact of western fashion ideologies and marketing practices on a global scale; comparison of retail and marketing strategies across fashion capitals; site visit to some retail establishments and meetings with representatives of companies. 3. <u>Fashion, Cities and their Consumers</u> Impact of culture on consumers' behaviors and preferences; shifting of consumer demographics and psychographics across countries; consumer sentiments and purchase motivations; emergence of new consumer base.
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	During the course of the program, the students will attend lectures, a series of intensive seminars, and an overseas trip. The purpose is to expose students to different aspects of the fashion industry across cities and regions of the world. Topics to be covered include fashion influences and trend spotting, consumer behavior, major retailers and their strategies for success, and production capabilities. The intensive seminars and site visits are arranged to bring a unique perspective to the program, in particular to students without a solid working experience in the fashion field. Students will learn the current managerial practices in sectors such as fashion manufacturing, merchandising, global supply management, retail and marketing, and product development and innovation. Students will also participate in different class seminars, site visits and meetings with industry leaders in the overseas trip. Cultural excursions will be arranged for the students to encourage further interchange with business leaders coming from a diverse cultural background.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)		
			a	b	c
	1. Coursework				
	- Site Visit Report	40%	✓	✓	✓
	- Reflective Essay	40%	✓	✓	✓
	- Class Participation	20%	✓	✓	✓
	Total	100 %			
	Case study can bring about a deep understanding of the market in the region, further the interaction with students of different cultures can enhance the leadership, organization and communication skill. Written assignment is designed for a reflection in an applied and theoretical manner.				
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:				
	▪ Lectures				30 Hrs.
	▪ Seminars and Site Visit				30 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:				
	▪ Assignment				40 Hrs.
	▪ Reading				80 Hrs.
	Total student study effort				180 Hrs.
Reading List and References	1. Saruchera, F. (2021) <i>Advanced Perspectives on Global Industry Transitions and Business Opportunities</i> . Hershey, Pennsylvania: Business Science Reference. 2. Brondoni, S. M. (2018) <i>Competitive Business Management: A Global Perspective</i> , Abingdon, Oxon: Routledge. 3. Deresky, H. (2017). <i>International Management: Managing Across Borders and Cultures: Text and Cases</i> . Boston: Pearson Higher Education.				

	4. Steenkamp, J. (2017). <i>Global Brand Strategy: World-wise Marketing in the Age of Branding</i>. London: Palgrave Macmillan. 5. Burns, L. D., Mullet, K. K., and Bryant, N. O. (2016). <i>The Business of Fashion: Designing, Manufacturing, and Marketing</i>. New York, NY, USA: Fairchild Books <u>Internet Resources</u> www.wgsn.com/
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

(Form AR 140) 8.2020